

into a separate folder. Much like spam email. Users can choose to delete, mark as known, or request more information about these senders. Conversations, now, can also be personalised with custom backgrounds, and for the first time, users can create and send polls within chat threads.

Elevating multitasking

While iOS 26 brought back Apple's attention to visual finesse, iPadOS 26 demonstrated how Apple is also using design to elevate functionality. That's particularly true for multitasking and window management.

iPadOS 26, for instance, delivers the biggest leap in multitasking since Stage Manager. A new windowing system lets users freely resize, move, and layer apps, much like a desktop-class interface. Users can now resize windows using corner handles, snap apps to screen edges, and view all open windows with a single tap.

The operating system also remembers the last used window position and size, restoring them when reopened. There's also a new Menu Bar, accessible via a swipe down or cursor hover, which consolidates app commands, search, and help tips into one sleek toolbar. Developers can now customise this menu, making each app experience feel more native and tailored.

Meanwhile, Files on iPadOS 26 is getting a much-needed upgrade. A new List View lets users view rich metadata in resizable columns, along with collapsible folders for better organisation. There's an unmistakable push to make iPads even more like laptops in workflow capability.

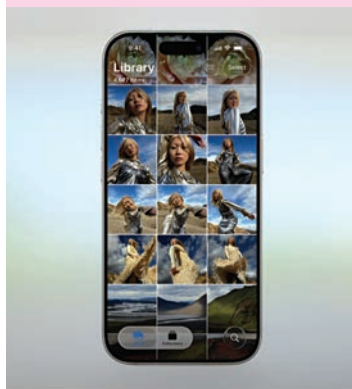
Perhaps the most technical addition: Background Tasks. Now, long-running processes initiated in apps will be visible as Live Activities, giving users transparency and control over what's running behind the scenes.

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We won! Apple's fixing its Photos app

Reintroducing a proper menu structure to the Photos app

Break out the champagne – we have won, all of us – because Apple is finally fixing one of the most annoying design changes it ever made to the Photos app. At its WWDC 2025 keynote on Monday, Apple announced that iOS 26 (yes, we're skipping all the way to 26 now...don't ask!) will reintroduce a proper menu structure to the Photos app. And, the announcement was received with claps and cheers, showing how badly it was needed.



The move comes after months of user frustration, social media rants, and likely more than a few strongly worded emails from photo hoarders everywhere. If you were among the millions quietly cursing your iPhone every time you had to scroll endlessly past selfies, screenshots and mysterious pet photos just to get to your albums – well, this update is definitely going to make life easier or at least, bring it back to normal.

So, last year with iOS 18, Apple decided to 'simplify' the Photos app by giving it a single-scroll design. Now, that pushed your manually created folders to the very bottom and instead started highlighting curated 'People & Pets' collections. Apple meant well, but users – especially those with thousands of images – weren't exactly thrilled about turning their photo library into a digital treasure hunt.

Many around me found this very annoying. Others were vocal on social media. And, it seems like Apple has been taking note as well.

"Many of you missed using tabs in the Photos app," admitted Craig Federighi, Senior Vice President for Software Engineering at Apple during the keynote. As part of the redesign, Photos will now feature two main tabs: Library and Collections. That's right! Your albums and favorites are once again just a tap away.

Is it a complete return to the old, beloved menu? Not quite. We're still only getting two main options upfront, and while the search icon has been thoughtfully lowered (thumbs up for thumb ergonomics), we're not seeing the full menu from the glory days just yet.

But here's the twist: it's also been given the shiny new "Liquid Glass" treatment which is Apple's latest design aesthetic. A big part of that experience is that menus are now adaptable.

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